PROSPER AWUNI

Security Engineer | SIEM/XDR | Microsoft Sentinel | KQL | Detection Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience delivering Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) capabilities in large enterprise environments. I have deep expertise in Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and Kusto Query Language (KQL), which I use daily for detection engineering, security analytics, and proactive threat hunting. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring a strong track record of building detection-as-code rules, automating response workflows, and aligning security operations to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I am highly effective at translating complex threat intelligence into actionable SIEM detections that reduce dwell time and improve the efficiency of security operations for managed security service provider (MSSP) and enterprise clients alike.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM/XDR Platforms:** Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Splunk (Security Information and Event Management)
- **Detection Engineering:** KQL (Kusto Query Language) analytics rules, detection-as-code, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection development, custom watchlists, workbooks, and playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (MDO), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender unified portal
- **Threat Hunting and Intelligence:** Proactive threat hunting using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques mapping, Indicators of Compromise (IoC) enrichment
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel Logic App playbooks, CrowdStrike Falcon Fusion SOAR, automated incident triage and response workflows
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting for security automation, Python scripting for data enrichment and integration, KQL for advanced log analytics
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Frameworks and Standards:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Cloud:** Microsoft Azure security, log analytics workspace administration, data connector management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Architect and maintain Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/XDR infrastructure including log analytics workspaces, data connectors, analytics rules, and playbooks supporting an 8,000-user estate.
- Write and maintain KQL-based detection rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, continuously tuning detections to reduce false positives and improve signal fidelity for the security operations team.
- Build and manage detection-as-code pipelines, version-controlling Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules and workbooks to enable rapid deployment and rollback of detections.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting sessions using KQL queries in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying attacker activity not surfaced by automated detections.
- Operate CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) across 8,000 endpoints, managing alert investigation, triage, and escalation workflows.

- Configure and maintain Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) policies, ensuring high-fidelity alert coverage across endpoint and identity attack surfaces.
- Develop and automate Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for common incident types by 40 per cent.
- Lead incident response activities following the NIST 800-61 framework, coordinating containment, eradication, and post-incident reviews with mapping to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Maintain Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) Conditional Access policies and manage Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) rollout across all users.
- Produce security analytics dashboards and management reporting using Microsoft Sentinel workbooks and Power BI.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Performed day-to-day SIEM operations in Microsoft Sentinel, investigating alerts, enriching Indicators of Compromise (IoC), and documenting incident timelines.
- Wrote KQL queries for security analytics, log investigation, and ad-hoc threat hunting across Microsoft Sentinel log analytics workspaces.
- Supported the onboarding of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) into the Microsoft Sentinel XDR environment.
- Assisted in developing and refining Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules and watchlists, improving detection coverage for phishing, lateral movement, and data exfiltration scenarios.
- Contributed to SOAR playbook development in Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert triage and enrichment workflows to improve analyst efficiency.
- Deployed and managed CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) across 8,000 endpoints, establishing detection baselines and policy configurations.
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to manage privileged account lifecycle and enforce least-privilege access.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, prioritising remediation by business risk and providing clear reporting to stakeholders.
- Mapped incident findings to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques to support continuous improvement of detection and response capabilities.
- Collaborated with the identity team on Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) Conditional Access and MFA implementation for 8,000 users.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)
IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Administered SIEM log ingestion and alert monitoring, investigating security events and escalating anomalies to senior engineers.
- Managed Microsoft Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) and MFA configurations, enforcing access control policies across a cloud-native SaaS platform.
- Implemented endpoint security policies using Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM), securing company and Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) endpoints.
- Conducted vulnerability scans and supported remediation activities, maintaining a reduced attack surface across cloud and on-premises infrastructure.
- Collaborated with development teams to embed security controls within the Software Development Lifecycle (SDLC) and supported ISO 27001 audit preparation.
- Used PowerShell scripting to automate routine security administration tasks, improving operational efficiency.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Architected a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/XDR deployment at UAL, integrating over 20 data connectors and building a library of 50 plus KQL detection rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Reduced alert triage time by 40 per cent through detection-as-code practices and SOAR playbook automation in Microsoft Sentinel.

- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) across 8,000 endpoints, achieving full endpoint visibility and a measurable reduction in attacker dwell time.
- Delivered proactive threat hunting programme using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, uncovering and remediating several previously undetected persistent threats.
- Led BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) deployment, eliminating standing privileged access for over 200 administrative accounts and enabling session recording for compliance.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification, owning the technical remediation programme and driving cross-departmental stakeholder engagement to meet all control requirements.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)